

Automated Infrastructure & Proactive Exception Tracking

Freight coordinator, Spain & Portugal · 120 employees · 1,000 loads/week · 39 years of operations

1. The Problem

Transiberia coordinates 1,000 loads per week across Spain and Portugal with no owned fleet — its value is long-term carrier relationships and operational coordination. Every core process — order entry, carrier assignment, delivery tracking, exception handling — runs manually across email, WhatsApp, Excel, and a 2005 SAP system acting as a CRM, not a TMS. There is no single source of truth; problems surface only after a customer complains.

3–5% EXCEPTION RATE/WK <i>Loads needing manual intervention</i>	20–30 hrs LOST WEEKLY <i>Reactive troubleshooting</i>	€80 COST PER LOAD <i>Target: €40 post-automation</i>	€4.16M ANNUAL PROCESS COST <i>Before delays or penalties</i>
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At a 5–6% margin, this leaves no room for error — the 12-month growth target (+25–40% volume, €16–21M revenue) is unreachable without first fixing the cost base. Scaling volume on today's operations scales the losses, not the profit.

2. Recommendation

Build a connected layer on top of the existing infrastructure — compose, not replace. SAP stays the system of record; three components are added and integrated:

n8n Orchestrator	Self-hosted, on-premise — reads SAP order emails, WhatsApp, PDFs and GPS webhooks into one connected view; writes back to SAP by email. No re-keying, no SAP Gateway or BTP licence required.
On-Premise AI (4 nodes)	Local Ollama LLM — document understanding, exception classifier, route-deviation detection and carrier scorer. Built into the Core from day one, zero add-on cost.
WhatsApp API + GPS	Carriers already use WhatsApp — messages are read automatically and fed into n8n. A GPS webhook (Webfleet/Teltonika) tracks live position against the expected route.

Core investment: €40,400 (€46,460 w/ 15% contingency) — well under the €500K budget. **Implementation: ~20 weeks** across 5 phases. **Payback: under a month.** **Year 1 net return: ~€1.93M.**

AI is built into the Core from day one. Plus €3,250–4,500 one-time, €462–700/mo running costs, and a client-side forward deployed engineer (~€88–95K/yr, since SilverTrust doesn't provide ongoing n8n maintenance) — total Year 1 investment €143–154K.

3. Why This Fits Transiberia Specifically

- **It preserves the carrier relationships.** Transiberia's edge is long-term trust with carriers, not technology — this changes how information flows, not who the parties are.
- **It meets carriers where they are.** WhatsApp integration is the specific answer to the fact that most Spanish and Portuguese carriers won't adopt a new platform.
- **No SAP re-platform, and no Gateway dependency.** A full S/4HANA migration typically runs \$1M–\$8M+, with over 60% of such projects exceeding budget. n8n reads SAP by plain email — no NetWeaver Gateway, no BTP licence, no SAP reconfiguration. The €100K–250K SAP-upgrade contingency flagged in earlier assessments is removed entirely.
- **AI-native from day one, not a later phase.** Every AI node ships as part of the Core build — it pays for itself in under a month, freeing budget and headcount to fund the +25–40% growth target immediately.

4. Next Step

Sign off Phase 0 — Discovery & Assessment: €6,800, fixed fee, 4 weeks — then straight into build, at a validated, fixed Core cost.

Delivers: process audit across SAP email flow, WhatsApp and exception handling; technical assessment covering SAP config, GPS choice and VPS sizing; and the final n8n / AI-node architecture design.

Assessment workshops with Marc and the operational leads are ready to begin next week.

Annex A — Business Case & Sources

Full calculations behind this brief, and every source used

Business Case & Detailed Calculations. Every number in this brief — assumptions, formulas and cell-level sources, including the SilverTrust Cost Detail day-rate breakdown and the Systems Cost & Net ROI comparison — is documented in the full Transiberia Business Case workbook, alongside the SilverTrust n8n Cost Breakdown & Consultancy Build Cost annex (per-integration costs, 3-tier day-rate comparison).

[Open the Business Case model →](#)

LABOR & COST BENCHMARKS (SPAIN)

Barcelona logistics coordinator salary *Glassdoor*

Spain employer social security contribution rate *Centre Gestor*

Spain standard working hours *Rivermate*

Spain statutory leave entitlement *Boundless HQ*

FREIGHT & LOGISTICS BENCHMARKS

Freight-forwarder margin benchmarks (5–6%) *GoFreight*

European road freight rate benchmark, €/load *Trans-road*

SAP, TECHNOLOGY & AI CONSULTING DAY-RATES

SAP ECC 6.0 end-of-mainstream-maintenance timeline *TalentMSH — ECC 6.0 End of Life*

SAP S/4HANA migration cost benchmark (\$1M–\$8M+, 60%+ over budget) *Tachyon Tech*

EU SME AI consulting market sizing, 2026 *EU SME AI Consulting Market 2026*

Not independently sourced: VPS, WhatsApp template and GPS tracking running costs are SilverTrust planning estimates pending final vendor quotes (Hetzner, Meta, Webfleet/Teltonika); the €65–70K forward deployed engineer cost is a SilverTrust planning figure set per Transiberia's direction, pending an actual hire — see the Business Case model above for cell-level detail.